
MEETING MINUTES

The Eighth Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

April 29, 2024

Executive Session 5:00 p.m.

Regular Meeting: 6:00 p.m.

Agenda

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - 7/0

Student Representatives - Darren Truong and Noah Yurasko

- II. Salute the Flag

- III. Executive Session

Executive session pursuant to G.L. c. 30A (a) (3): the Medford School Committee will convene in Executive Session to discuss strategy in preparation for negotiations with **Medford Educational Secretaries (AFSCME Council 93), Teamsters Local 25 Custodians, Medford Teachers Association for Kids Corner, Medford Teachers Association for Paraprofessionals, Carpenters (SEIU Local 888)** because an open meeting will have a detrimental effect on the bargaining position of the Committee and the Chair so declares.

Motion to enter executive session by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passed

- IV. Consent Agenda

- Bills and Payrolls
- Regular School Committee Minutes, **April 8, 2024**
- Special Meeting Minutes, **April 24, 2024**
- Recommendation to Approve a \$1,000 Donation to the String Ensemble from the Schmit Family
- Recommendation to Approve Travel to Puerto Rico (February 2025)

Motion to sever donations from Consent Agenda by Member Graham, second by Member Ruseau - 7/0 passed

Motion to approve consent agenda by Member Graham, second by Member Olapade - 7/0 passed

- Recommendation to Approve a \$1,000 Donation to the String Ensemble from the Schmit Family
- Recommendation to Approve Travel to Puerto Rico (February 2025)

Motion to approve \$1,000 donation by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passed

Motion approve field trip to Puerto Rico by Member Graham, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passed

V. Report of Subcommittees - None

VI. Report of the Superintendent

1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
2. **Arts Programs Update and Recognition of Orchestra Gold Medal** - Suzanne Fee, Coordinator of Fine Arts, and Haley Rello, Coordinator of Performing Arts

Motion to suspend rules and take 2024-24 out of order by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passed

First read of 2024-24 (full resolution under VIII.)

Alicia Hunt, Director of Planning, Development and Sustainability

Respectfully asks for the vote on this resolution to wait until after the HVAC presentation.

Motion to table 2024-24 until after the presentation by Member Branley, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passed

Motion to revert back to regular business by Member Ruseau, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passes

3. **HVAC Update** - Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent, Brenda Pike, and Alicia Hunt

Motion to approve the Andrews and McGlynn projects by Member Graham, second by Member Ruseau - 7/0 passed

4. **Suspension and Discipline Report**- Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
5. **Rate Card** - Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent

Motion to approve pool and facilities rates by Member Reinfeld, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passed

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm) - None

VII. Continued Business -None

VIII. New Business

2024-20 Offered by Member Ruseau

The Medford School Committee may send a delegate and alternate delegate to the Massachusetts Association of School Committees(MASC)/Massachusetts Association of School Superintendents (MASS) Annual Joint Conference for the purpose of voting during the delegate assembly on the resolutions of the MASC.

The conference is Wednesday, November 6 through Friday, November 8, with the delegate assembly being held on Friday, November 8.

Voting is presently only allowed in person, and thus it is recommended that only members who are able to and are planning to attend the conference be nominated.

Are there nominations for an alternate delegate?
Are there nominations for a delegate?

Date Submitted: April 19, 2024
Date Requested to be on Agenda: April 29, 2024

Motion to nominate Member Olapade as the Alternate Delegate to the MASC Conference by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passed

Motion to nominate Member Ruseau as the Delegate of the MASC Conference by Member Graham, second by member Olapade - 7/0 passed

2024-21 Offered by Member Graham

Be it resolved that the Strategic and Capital Planning subcommittee will meet to review and update the district's Capital Needs Assessment and Planning document. Be it further resolved that the subcommittee will devise a process to ensure regular annual maintenance of the plan. Be it also resolved that the subcommittee will provide a report to the full School Committee no later than June 10, 2024.

Date Submitted: April 20, 2024
Date Requested to be on Agenda: Apr 29, 2024

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passed

2024-22 Offered by Member Graham

Be it resolved that the Special Education and Behavioral Health Subcommittee will meet to discuss whether the Curtis-Tufts School should be co-located with the Medford High School Campus to improve educational outcomes for Curtis-Tufts students.

Be it further resolved that the Subcommittee will invite current and former students and staff to provide comment.

Be it also resolved that the committee will report back to the School Committee on whether the Curtis-Tufts program should be co-located **no later than June 3, 2024** because this information is critical to the progress of the Medford Comprehensive High School Building Committee as it completes the district's educational profile.

Date Submitted: April 20, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: April 29, 2024

Jack Haverty
Watervale Road
Medford, MA

Mr. Haverty is also Assistant Principal, Special Education Department Head at Next Wave/Full Circle Somerville Public Schools

- Spoke on pros outweighing cons to merging Curtis Tufts into the Medford High School complex and both being in one facility.
- Offered to let us view the wing at Somerville High School for the alternative school.

Motion to approve by Member Ruseau, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 passed

2024-23 Offered by Member Reinfeld

Be it resolved that the Subcommittee for Curriculum, Instruction, Assessment & Accountability meet with the Assistant Superintendent of Academics and Instruction and other relevant staff to discuss the development of a process to review and assess recently adopted curricula and assessment tools across the district, and to identify the key stakeholders, timelines, and protocols to be involved in these review, consistent with the policies described in Section I of the Medford School Committee Online Policy Manual.

Date Submitted: April 23, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: April 29, 2024

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Branley - 7/0 passed

2024-24 Offered by Member Ruseau, Member Reinfeld and Member Olapade

Resolution on the End of Fossil Fuel Building Equipment Purchases

Whereas the buildings of the Medford Public Schools are exclusively the responsibility of the Medford School Committee pursuant to Massachusetts General Law Chapter 71 Section 68;

Whereas the Inflation Reduction Act and the Bipartisan Infrastructure Law have both provided significant opportunities for schools to end our dependence on fossil fuel infrastructure;

Whereas the climate crisis is an existential threat to the survival of our species and countless other species we share our planet with;

Whereas the climate crisis is primarily caused by human activity through the release of greenhouse gasses; and

Whereas today's leaders must take action now to ensure a sustainable future for generations to come; now, therefore, Be it Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. bans the purchase of new or replacement fossil fuel powered equipment used to operate our school facilities, such as HVAC equipment and kitchen equipment;
2. may authorize the purchase of banned equipment in emergency situations at a regular or special meeting of the Committee; and
3. must authorize equipment purchases covered by this resolution regardless of the revenue source, such as municipal funding, or grants from governmental or non-governmental organizations.

Date Submitted: April 24, 2024

Date Requested to be on Agenda: April 29, 2024

Motion to take 2024-23 from table Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passed

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Olapade - 7/0 passed

IX. Reports Requested - None

X. Condolences

XI. Next Meeting

May 6, 2024 at 5:00 p.m. - Special Meeting, Public Budget Hearing, Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

May 6, 2024 at 6:00 p.m. - Regular Meeting, Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XII. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member Ruseau, second by Member Graham - 7/0 passed

Meeting adjourned at 8:42 pm